

YEARBOOK OF GLOBAL CLIMATE ACTION 2026

Executive Summary

The Global Climate Action Agenda

Climate action by cities, regions and other sub national entities, businesses, international organizations and civil society – known as non-Party stakeholders (NPS) in the UNFCCC process, together with Parties, has been instrumental to the advances made in the past decade towards achieving the goals of the Paris Agreement. Both the appointment of Climate High-Level Champions (CHLC) in 2015 and the launch of the Marrakech Partnership for Global Climate Action (MP) the following year helped kickstart a more structured approach to scaling up the global response to climate change, and enabled a better connection between the Convention and the many voluntary and collaborative actions that were already taking place, fostering NPS and Parties' collaboration.

In this new stage, the **Global Climate Action Agenda (GCAA)** is focused on building on the significant progress made over the last 10 years and supporting the implementation of already agreed outcomes from the UNFCCC process, such as the first global stocktake (GST). GCAA is now structured under **six thematic axes**, each with a set of **objectives**.

Objectives under the six thematic axes of the GCAA



With a strong emphasis on implementation, a guiding principle under the GCAA 2026-2030 is to build on the existing on-going work by means of **Plans to Accelerate Solutions (PAS)**. Each PAS is a concise, multi-stakeholder, action-oriented workplan summarizing key actions to unblock progress and voluntary commitments to accelerate implementation of high-impact solutions to deliver on the objectives.

PAS

The Action Agenda is advancing: 84 per cent of PAS reported progress after one year of implementation. About 46 per cent of them reported progress on tools, knowledge and standards and 24 per cent demonstrated policy or market uptake by governments or businesses, while 20 per cent reported finance committed or flowing and 10 per cent reported measurable results for people, land or emissions.

The Action Agenda is executing: 51 per cent of the 738 actions planned for 2026 were completed and 14 PAS delivered all their planned actions for 2026.

The Action Agenda is going fast: of the 40 PAS with quantitative targets, 38 per cent are on pace or ahead, while 38 per cent reported mixed progress against targets and 25 per cent are delayed.

Action is trending in the right direction on more than half of the objectives (16 of 30). Three show mixed results and three are stalling. For eight objectives there is not enough data yet to tell.

NAZCA

Another underlying principle of GCAA 2026–2030 is strengthened transparency of voluntary climate action. Key to this, the **Non-State Actors Zone for Climate Action (NAZCA)** portal is the main venue through which actors can demonstrate credible progress, highlighting where action is delivering results and where further efforts are needed, and providing greater visibility to the contribution of NPS to the implementation of the Paris Agreement.

In particular, the portal tracks the progress of **Cooperative Climate Initiatives (CCIs)**, whose information is collected through voluntary registration. Defined as voluntary institutional arrangements jointly organized by multiple entities, including Parties and NPS, CCIs include multi-stakeholder partnerships, joint declarations, coalitions, alliances, and other types of voluntary arrangements where multiple organizations work together towards achieving a clearly defined climate-related goal, aligned with the goals of the Paris Agreement and shared by the entities within the CCI. The number of registered CCIs has grown steadily over the years, increasing from 163 in 2023 to **312** in 2026.

The secretariat invites CCIs registered on NAZCA to report progress annually under a **common reporting framework**, providing registered CCIs with the opportunity to demonstrate key actions undertaken, report progress on self-identified targets, and share challenges and opportunities encountered. The information reported by CCIs strengthens the credibility of their commitments and helps track their progress, contributing to greater transparency and a better understanding of the collective impact of climate action by NPS.

This year, **83** registered CCIs participated in the process and submitted progress information within the requested timeframe, compared to **48** in 2023. While this may be partially due to the increased number of registered CCIs, the growing number of CCIs reporting progress can be considered as encouraging in the context of transparent climate action.

The Yearbook of Global Climate Action

First launched in 2017, the Yearbook of Global Climate Action is a key tool developed by the CHLC, with the support of the UNFCCC secretariat, to track progress, impacts and results in the implementation of climate action, and to identify best practices and lessons learned.

The 2025 Yearbook launched the GCAA's new structure, with chapters covering each of the six axes and presenting a trend analysis of global progress under the axes' objectives in the past decade, based on a set of tailored **global socio-economic indicators (GSIs)**.

The full edition of the **2026 Yearbook** – celebrating both the tenth iteration of its series and the Marrakech Partnership's 10-year anniversary – is now available as a webpage here . It builds on the structure and contents of the 2025 edition, with dedicated chapters covering the six axes under the GCAA. Each chapter provides an update of the GSIs for comparability, where indicators are assigned one of three states based on its direction of travel between the value reported in the 2025 Yearbook and the latest available data: ***progress***, where the latest value has moved in the desired direction; ***no progress***, where it is flat or has moved the wrong way; or ***data insufficient***, where there is no comparable baseline. The 2026 Yearbook also introduces for the first time information on progress and results reported by Plans to Accelerate Solutions (PAS), in line with the Action Agenda's 2026-2030 vision. As such, in addition to an overview of CCIs progress as reported to NAZCA under the common reporting framework, chapters also provide a list of PAS per axis.

For the purposes of this **Executive Summary**, the information provided in the full edition was summarized in a table for each axis, providing an overview of global progress and remaining gaps as identified by the GSIs, as well as information on CCIs and PAS.

Axis 1. Transitioning Energy, Industry, and Transport

Across **Axis 1**, clean power is now **scaling faster** than any other part of the energy system, while progress in energy efficiency, decarbonization of heavy industry and the transition away from fossil fuels lag behind.
Of the **25 global indicators** under this axis: **17** show *progress* | **8** show *no progress*

Global Progress

- Seventeen per cent **increase in renewable energy capacity** between 2024 and 2025
- **Road transport is electrifying quickly**: electric vehicles made up a quarter of light-duty sales in 2025, while public charging points reached more than seven million and zero-emission heavy-duty vehicle sales jumped from 1.8 per cent in 2024 to nine per cent in 2025
- The number of **people without electricity and without clean cooking continues to fall** steadily, albeit below what is necessary – with the latter reaching a decrease of nearly four per cent between 2023 and 2024
- Explicit **fossil fuel subsidies fell** from USD 1.4 trillion in 2022 to USD 0.725 trillion in 2024

Remaining Gaps

- The rate of improvement of energy intensity **remained at one per cent** in 2024 (against the four per cent a year needed by 2030)
- The carbon intensity of steel production also **stayed flat** from last check (2023) at 1,920 $kgCO_2$ per tonne in 2024
- Oil & gas **methane emissions increased** from 71.5 Mt CH_4 in 2024 to around 72.3 Mt CH_4 in 2025, while oil and gas production covered by **methane pledges fell** from 80 per cent in 2024 to ~75 per cent in 2025

CCIs reporting progress under NAZCA

- CCIs reporting as contributing to this axis: **30**
- Most frequently reported CCI function: *Knowledge production, sharing and capacity-building*
- Most frequently reported climate action types: *Capacity-building* and *Generation of knowledge products*

Plans to Accelerate Solutions (PAS)

- Total PAS under this axis: **34**, covering **4** objectives
- Number of PAS sharing progress in the October 2026 reporting round: **24**

Axis 2. Stewarding Forests, Oceans and Biodiversity

Across **Axis 2**, progress is evident in expanding finance, conservation efforts and recognition of **Indigenous and community rights.** However, these advances have not yet reversed the continuing degradation of forests and ecosystems.
Of the **11 global indicators** under this axis: **5** show *progress* | **2** show *no progress* | **4** have *insufficient data*

Global Progress

- Deforestation **slowed** in 2025 (nearly 14 per cent decrease in comparison with 2024)
- 11.8 million hectares are **under active restoration** with projects in 2026 (up from 10.6 Mha in 2024)
- Marine protected areas **reached 10 per cent** in 2025 (up from 8.4 per cent in 2024 and from 4.1 per cent in 2015)

Remaining Gaps

- Despite a **significant reduction** since 2018, forest degradation persists at a high level and has ticked up recently (from 63 Mha in 2022 to 65.4 Mha in 2024)
- Significant gaps remain in harmonizing monitoring frameworks across the three Rio Conventions – a key gap for Rio Synergies/li>

CCIs reporting progress under NAZCA

- CCIs reporting as contributing to this axis: **13**
- Most frequently reported CCI function: *Advocacy, policy engagement and awareness-raising*
- Most frequently reported climate action types: *Advocacy and policy engagement* and *Generation of knowledge products*

Plans to Accelerate Solutions (PAS)

- Total PAS under this axis: **12**, covering **3** objectives
- Number of PAS sharing progress in the October 2026 reporting round: **12**

Axis 3. Transforming Agriculture and Food Systems

Across **Axis 3**, some sources of **farm emissions are becoming less intensive and food security is improving**, but food loss is not.
Of the **10 global indicators** under this axis: **5** show *progress* | **4** show *no progress* | **1** has *insufficient data*

Global Progress

- **Emissions intensity declined** for enteric fermentation and rice cultivation between 2022 and 2023, while **ruminant meat productivity rose** from 30 to 31 kg per hectare between 2022 and 2024
- **Food security is improving**: undernourishment fell from 9.1 to 7.8 per cent between 2023 and 2025, and the share of people unable to afford a healthy diet fell from 37.4 to 32.7 per cent between 2021 and 2025

Remaining Gaps

- **Emissions intensity** for manure management **increased** between 2022 and 2023 and held flat for soil fertilization
- **Food loss held at 13 per cent** of production between 2021 and 2023
- There are currently **no global indicators** tracking the resilience of food systems to climate shocks or the finance reaching small-scale farmers

CCIs reporting progress under NAZCA

- CCIs reporting as contributing to this axis: **16**
- Most frequently reported CCI function: *Implementation of projects*
- Most frequently reported climate action type: *Generation of knowledge products*

Plans to Accelerate Solutions (PAS)

- Total PAS under this axis: **16**, covering **3** objectives
- Number of PAS sharing progress in the October 2026 reporting round: **13**

Axis 4. Building Resilience for Cities, Infrastructure and Water

Across **Axis 4**, progress in policies, planning and institutional readiness is outpacing improvements in **physical resilience**. Cities, regions and countries are increasingly integrating adaptation into climate strategies, expanding early warning systems and improving access to essential services. Yet exposure to climate hazards continues to grow: more people lived in flood zones and water-stressed basins in 2025 than in 2015, which highlights a persistent gap between commitments, implementation and measurable resilience outcomes.
Of the **19 global indicators** under this axis: **3** show *progress* | **0** shows *no progress* | **16** have *insufficient data*

Global Progress

- Cities are increasingly central to national climate plans, as **the number of NDCs with strong urban content doubled** from 52 to 104 (2024–2026)
- The **number of cities with people-centred adaptation measures rose** from 308 to 392 between 2024 and 2025
- **The number of countries with multi-hazard early warning systems rose** from 108 to 119 between 2024 and 2025

Remaining Gaps

- The number of **people living in water-stressed basins is higher** in 2025 than it was in 2015
- Globally comparable evidence on the climate resilience of sanitation infrastructure and services remains limited, highlighting a **critical gap in measuring adaptation implementation and outcomes**
- On zero waste, **only 6.9 per cent of material inputs came from secondary materials** in 2021, and **only 22.3 per cent of e-waste was formally recycled** in 2022

CCIs reporting progress under NAZCA

- CCIs reporting as contributing to this axis: **18**
- Most frequently reported CCI function: *Knowledge production, sharing and capacity-building projects*
- Most frequently reported climate action type: *Capacity-building*

Plans to Accelerate Solutions (PAS)

- Total PAS under this axis: **19**, covering **5** objectives
- Number of PAS sharing progress in the October 2026 reporting round: **11**

Axis 5. Fostering Human and Social Development

Across **Axis 5**, global indicators point to progress in poverty reduction, food security, **disaster preparedness and green employment**, but significant gaps remain in quantifying how these gains translate into greater climate resilience. While adaptation planning and early warning coverage are expanding, the implementation of climate-resilient health systems, adaptive social protection, education and cultural heritage protection remains insufficiently captured by global datasets. These gaps limit the ability to assess whether the most vulnerable populations are becoming better protected against escalating climate risks.
Of the **12 global indicators** under this axis: **5** show *progress* | **1** shows *no progress* | **6** have *insufficient data*

Global Progress

- **Renewable energy jobs reached 16.6 million** in 2024 (up from 16.2 million in 2023)
- **Extreme poverty is now expected to fall** from 831 million people to 811 million between 2025 and 2026, while the **number of people experiencing hunger decreased** from ~659 million to ~645 million between 2024 and 2025
- The number of **developing countries with updated National Adaptation Plans (NAPs) rose** from 59 to 81 between 2024 and 2026

Remaining Gaps

- **Women's share of renewable energy jobs stayed stagnant** at 32 per cent between 2024 and 2025
- **Comparable global indicators remain limited** for climate education, adaptation skills and workforce readiness, as well as global monitoring for the protection of cultural heritage, traditional knowledge and cultural practices against climate risks

CCIs reporting progress under NAZCA

- CCIs reporting as contributing to this axis: **18**
- Most frequently reported CCI function: *Implementation of projects*
- Most frequently reported climate action types: *Enhancing collaboration* and *Generation of knowledge products*

Plans to Accelerate Solutions (PAS)

- Total PAS under this axis: **14**, covering **4** objectives
- Number of PAS sharing progress in the October 2026 reporting round: **11**

Axis 6. Unleashing Enablers and Accelerators, including on Finance, Technology and Capacity Building

The infrastructure available for tracking global trends across the wide range of topics covered in **Axis 6** is similarly diverse. Tracking is strongest for financial flows and **capacity support**. Non-CO_2 emissions give the clearest off-track signal, and several objectives still rely on one indicator or none.

Of the **19 global indicators** under this axis: **9** show *progress* | **4** show *no progress* | **6** have *insufficient data*

Global Progress

- Climate finance **passed USD 2 trillion** in 2024, with progress both in global public and private finance
- The number of **countries with green public procurement frameworks increased** from 49 in 2022 to 54 in 2025
- Developing countries **receiving NAP support rose** from 89 to 92 between 2024 and 2026 and **readiness funding grew** from USD 642 million to USD 749 million between 2024 and 2025

Remaining Gaps

- **Adaptation finance is fluctuating, and decreased** from USD 81.5 billion in 2022 to USD 64.1 billion in 2024
- **Non-CO_2 emissions are off track**: energy methane stayed flat at 144 Mt between 2024 and 2025, and agricultural N_2O rose from 7.46 to 7.57 Mt between 2022 and 2023

CCIs reporting progress under NAZCA

- CCIs reporting as contributing to this axis: **30**
- Most frequently reported CCI function: *Knowledge production, sharing and capacity-building*
- Most frequently reported climate action type: *Capacity-building*

Plans to Accelerate Solutions (PAS)

- Total PAS under this axis: **36**, covering **10** objectives
- Number of PAS sharing progress in the October 2026 reporting round: **30**

Yearbook of Global Climate Action 2026
unfccc.int/resource/yearbook-global-climate-action-2026

United Nations Climate Change
unfccc.int